

All That is Gold Does Not Glitter: How Operation Gold Revolutionized
Intelligence Amidst The Cold War

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Historical Paper

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Process Paper

This paper concerns Operation Gold, a Cold War-era American wiretapping operation that required a 1,476-foot tunnel to be constructed under Berlin, and its significance in history.

While looking through books at my local library, I happened to come across the book *Betrayal in Berlin* by Steve Vogel. I became fascinated by the thrilling topic, partly due to its bold nature, and started to research more about the operation. Eventually, I was able to find declassified Central Intelligence Agency documents, which made the connection of this topic to the theme of Frontiers in History very clear.

As someone who enjoys critical analysis, I chose to present my research in the historical paper category. There were not a lot of clear photographs taken due to the discrete nature of the operation, which influenced me to select the paper category; I also felt that the topic would best match with a paper.

I conducted initial research using multiple sources from *Betrayal in Berlin*, and soon found the Central Intelligence Agency's official documents on Operation Gold, housed on the Internet Archive. With a multitude of sources available to cross-check the construction phase, I started to draft the American and British engineers' processes for building the tunnel. My main focus quickly shifted to showing the reader how risky yet crucial the operation was, to showcase the true extent of the operation.

Once I had an understanding of the tunnel's construction, I structured my research into three main parts. I researched and wrote a background on the tensions leading up to the operation by consulting primary sources of those involved in the project's inception and general background on the Cold War's start. Next, I analyzed the Soviet Union's reception of Operation Gold, mainly by finding Berlin newspaper commentary and caricatures. The Central Intelligence

Agency had created a report devoted to the press reception of the operation, which was very helpful in obtaining newspapers that were not present in archival collections. Lastly, the significance of the tunnel for the United States was written, using the reported outcome of the operation from the Central Intelligence Agency, as well as American newspapers.

Operation Gold proved to be invaluable as a frontier in history. The Central Intelligence Agency, previously thought to be nowhere near the prowess of the *Komitet Gosudarstvennoy Bezopasnosti* (KGB), formed a name for itself. This led to the United States gaining power over the whole world as even KGB officials were astonished at the scale of the operation. Operation Gold inspired the United States to pursue bolder espionage operations, directly promoting the United States' growth to become a global superpower. The Central Intelligence Agency was also forced to partner with their 'enemy' — the National Security Agency — directly leading to the United States maintaining an intelligence grasp on the whole world. Thus, the following paper makes the argument that Operation Gold advanced the United States' intelligence powers, and became a frontier in counterintelligence and espionage.

Historical Paper

Operation Gold was a 1954-1956 Cold War espionage operation, aimed at gaining vital Soviet Union strategies by the United States and Great Britain. Before the operation, the United States lost critical intelligence information on the Soviet Union due to the emergence of the Cold War. However, the United States steadily rose into being the world's main global superpower by the end of the Cold War — not just through technological advancements, but through espionage and intelligence. With the partnership of the United States Central Intelligence Agency (CIA) and Britain's Secret Intelligence Service (SIS), Operation Gold revolutionized the intelligence quality of the West, while showing the world how daring the United States could be. Thus, it may be said that Operation Gold redefined the intelligence powers of the United States, while posing as a frontier for counterintelligence and espionage operations.

Background

On February 1, 1943, the United States started Project VENONA, a counterintelligence program aimed at decrypting Soviet Union intelligence radio messages. However, when VENONA was betrayed to the Soviets by *Komitet Gosudarstvennoy Bezopasnosti* (KGB) spies in 1949,¹ the Soviet Union switched from radio transmissions to landlines — known infamously as “Black Friday” to intelligence officials.² The loss of critical intelligence efforts amidst growing Cold War tensions plunged the United States into the dark.

Since Soviet radio transmissions could no longer be tapped, Peter Lunn, head of the SIS's Vienna station, decided to dig a seventy-foot tunnel from the post-WWII British sector of Austria

¹ Steve Vogel. “Dwight Eisenhower Built up American Intelligence at a Crucial Moment.” History News Network, September 20, 2020, <https://historynewsnetwork.org/article/177379>. And “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” The Cold War Museum, https://web.archive.org/web/20120902022151/http://www.coldwar.org/articles/50s/berlin_tunnel.asp.

² Steve Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin: The True Story of The Cold War's Most Audacious Espionage Operation* (New York: HarperCollins Publishers Inc, 2019), 21.

to the Soviet sector, to place a physical tap on copper landlines.³ Lunn's idea, dubbed Operation Silver, was conducted in 1949, where it quickly became "a greater success even than had been hoped for."⁴ However, the American sentiment still did not improve; it was thought that without quality intelligence, "the world [was] racing toward catastrophe,"⁵ making the need for new intel clearer than ever.

Operation Gold

In 1954, Peter Lunn, now the head of the SIS's Berlin station, contemplated "an even bolder enterprise"⁶ after Operation Silver's success: to tap Soviet communication lines in Berlin. The SIS deemed that the most information was housed in "three Soviet cables, running close to the boundary of the American enclave [...] which juts deeply into the Soviet zone"⁷ — and that was where the United States came in.

The United States was already receiving updates on Operation Silver's progress and knew of "infinitely greater possibilities"⁸ to gain intelligence; hence, when approached by the SIS in February 1954, they "needed no persuading and were at once enthusiastic"⁹ to participate in the joint operation, titled Operation Gold.¹⁰ The United States sent their team of experts,

³ "Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch." And David Edmund Murphy and Sergei Aleksandrovich Kondrashev and George Bailey, *Battleground Berlin: CIA vs KGB in the Cold War* (New Haven: Yale University Press, 1997), 206. And David Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin* (New York: The Overlook Press, 2003), 22-37. And George Blake, *No Other Choice: An Autobiography* (New York: Simon & Schuster, 1990), 8-11. And Peter Kross, "Operation Gold: The CIA's Berlin Tunnel," *Military Heritage* 14, no. 6 (Spring 2013): 12-16, <https://warfarehistorynetwork.com/article/operation-gold-the-cias-berlin-tunnel/>. And Roger Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor: The Secret Lives of Agent George Blake* (London: Aurum Press Ltd, 2013), 149. And Tennent Harrington Bagley, *Spymaster: Startling Cold War Revelations of a Soviet KGB Chief* (New York: Skyhorse Publishing, 2013), 134. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 26. And Vulcan To The Sky Trust, October 30, 2020, <https://vulcantothesky.org/articles/cold-war-stories-operation-gold-stopwatch/>.

⁴ Blake, *No Other Choice*, 9.

⁵ History News Network, "Dwight Eisenhower Built up American Intelligence at a Crucial Moment."

⁶ Blake, *No Other Choice*, 20.

⁷ *Ibid.*, 21.

⁸ *Ibid.*

⁹ *Ibid.*

¹⁰ *Ibid.*

including CIA head of BOB (the Berlin Operating Base) Bill Harvey, to meet with SIS experts. It is important to note that SIS agent George Blake “kept the minutes of the meeting.”¹¹

The CIA resolved to dig the tunnel, store recordings of tapped conversations, and process the telegraphic material in Washington.¹² On the other hand, the SIS would dig a shaft to the wires, tap the cables, and process the voice recordings in London.¹³ The location of the tunnel would be from Schönbergweg in the American Sector of Berlin, all the way to Schönefelder Chaussee in the Soviet Sector, where the cables were situated.¹⁴ The tunnel’s start would also be covered by an American “radar intercept station,”¹⁵ reported to have “blueprints [...] so crazy”¹⁶ that a civilian engineer asked, “[w]hy build a cellar big enough to drive through with a dump truck?”¹⁷ The clandestine basement’s true purpose was to store excavated soil.¹⁸

The American engineers began digging on September 2, 1954.¹⁹ The engineers planned to dig twelve feet below the warehouse basement to start the tunnel, only to discover a perched water table after digging four-and-a-half feet.²⁰ After inspection, on October 6, Harvey and Lunn

¹¹ Blake, *No Other Choice*, 22.

¹² Vulcan To The Sky Trust, “Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch.”

¹³ Ibid.

¹⁴ Bagley, *Spymaster*, 92. And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 156. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 213-214. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 86. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 98.

¹⁵ “A Look Back... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” Central Intelligence Agency, June 26, 2009, <https://web.archive.org/web/20090715053316/https://www.cia.gov/news-information/featured-story-archive/the-berlin-tunnel-exposed.html>. And Gerard Fellon, “Engineering the Berlin Tunnel,” *Studies in Intelligence* 52, no. 1 (March 2008),

[https://web.archive.org/web/20090513190505/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/csi-studies/studies/vol-52-no-1/pdf-files/\(U\)%20Berlin%20Tunnel%20\(Web\).pdf](https://web.archive.org/web/20090513190505/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/csi-studies/studies/vol-52-no-1/pdf-files/(U)%20Berlin%20Tunnel%20(Web).pdf). And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 157-161. And History News Network, “Dwight Eisenhower Built up American Intelligence at a Crucial Moment.” And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 213-214. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 97. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 105. And Vulcan To The Sky Trust, “Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch.”

¹⁶ Fellon, “Engineering the Berlin Tunnel.” And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 161. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 105. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 105. And Vulcan To The Sky Trust, “Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch.”

¹⁷ Ibid.

¹⁸ Ibid.

¹⁹ Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 161. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 219. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 100. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 132-135.

²⁰ Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 161. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 220. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 102-105. And The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 98, 157-158.

allowed construction above the water table. Although this would make the tunnel vulnerable to detection due to proximity to the surface, they decided to take a chance, with Harvey mentioning that the tunnel could still succeed “if carefully done.”²¹

On the contrary, officials in Washington and London became skeptical of the operation due to the new hurdle of the water table, along with the tunnel having a calculated distance of 1,476 feet.²² They remarked, “[n]o one had ever tunneled under clandestine conditions with the expectation of hitting a target two inches in diameter and 27 inches below a main German/Soviet highway.”²³

With the help of a specialized shield to withstand potential “Soviet [...] 60-ton tanks riding down Schönefelder Chaussee,”²⁴ the tunnel was completed on February 28, 1955. American engineers were then swapped with British Royal Engineers to conduct the wiretap, who completed the task by May 21.²⁵ Only two of the three target cables were tapped, as the third was heavily damaged.²⁶

The CIA had set up an operations room in the warehouse, and the Royal Engineers created a tap chamber to amplify the intel obtained from the cables. Ampex tape recorders,

²¹ Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 102-103. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 157-158.

²² Central Intelligence Agency, “A Look Back... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 156-161. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 223. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 105. And “The Berlin Spy Tunnel.” Alliierten Museum, <https://www.alliiertenmuseum.de/en/objekt/the-berlin-spy-tunnel/>. And “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956.” *Clandestine Services History*, June 24, 1968, 34, <https://web.archive.org/web/20170118070821/https://www.cia.gov/library/readingroom/docs/CIA-RDP07X00001R000100010001-9.pdf>. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 102.

²³ *Clandestine Services History*, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 34. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 160.

²⁴ *Clandestine Services History*, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 23-31. And Fellon, “Engineering the Berlin Tunnel.” And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 161. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 220. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 160. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 105.

²⁵ *Clandestine Services History*, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 36. And “Intelligence Events Timeline — May 11, 1955.” Central Intelligence Agency, <https://www.cia.gov/legacy/museum/successful-completion-of-the-berlin-tunnel-operation-gold/>. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 222. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 110. And The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 191.

²⁶ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 192.

amplifiers, oscillators, power ducts, electrical panels, and machine racks were placed and inspected carefully by CIA and SIS officials, for it would be embarrassing if the tap failed due to faulty Western equipment.²⁷

BOB received an influx of Russian conversations, and translators regularly worked sixteen hour shifts to type up summaries.²⁸ The team regularly sent their tape reels to Washington in boxes marked as “uranium samples.” as a cover.²⁹ This story was highly plausible as the Soviets were mining uranium for their nuclear program. With the purposeful distribution of this story, the United States was “shown” to be daring as it was conducting espionage operations on the frontlines; consequently, the United States began to garner power.³⁰ While the tapes would go to Washington, all the audio recordings went to London for transcription.

At precisely 12:50 A.M., on April 22, 1956, Soviet troops started digging on Schönefelder Chaussee, under the pretense that they were fixing the cable’s faults after heavy spring floods.³¹ It was a major alarm for BOB officers — especially when the Soviet troops discovered the tap chamber’s roof at 2 A.M.³² The Soviets knew where to dig for the tunnel “from advance information by [their] friend,” George Blake, an SIS defector and KGB mole.³³

²⁷ See Appendix A. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 225. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 164.

²⁸ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 191.

²⁹ Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 156. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 193.

³⁰ Ibid.

³¹ Alliierten Museum, “The Berlin Spy Tunnel.” And Central Intelligence Agency, “A Look Back... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” And Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 47-49. And Fellon, “Engineering the Berlin Tunnel.” And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 182. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 229-231. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 148-153. And The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 256-265.

³² Alliierten Museum, “The Berlin Spy Tunnel.” And Central Intelligence Agency, “A Look Back... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” And Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956.” And Fellon, “Engineering the Berlin Tunnel,” 47-49. And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 182. And Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 229-231. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 148-153. And The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 262-265.

³³ Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 232-233. And Stafford, *Spies Beneath Berlin*, 160. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 263.

The tunnel quickly fell into the hands of the Soviet Union, where it became a spectacle of the worldwide press.

Despite being caught, the 6.5 million dollars expended were worth it: Operation Gold successfully captured fifty-thousand tape reels, 443,000 transcribed conversations, forty-thousand hours of telephone conversations, and 6-million hours of teletype traffic.³⁴ The audacious operation, even with its short span of eleven months and eleven days, had paid off: both the United States and Great Britain had gained crucial intelligence through an engineering marvel, whose magnitude had never been seen by the world before.

Legacy

Before Operation Gold, the CIA lacked the resources of the National Security Agency (NSA), which damaged “the [CIA]’s credibility”³⁵ as their reports “were regularly contradicted”³⁶ by NSA intelligence. CIA Director Allen Dulles had hired NSA cryptologist Frank Rowlett to decrypt Operation Gold’s teletype traffic in Washington, at the price of less cooperation with the NSA.³⁷ However, when the CIA needed more people to decrypt material, they asked the NSA for assistance. Cooperation between the two parties was forced, but became a frontier for improved cooperation and thus improved intelligence for the United States

³⁴ Alliierten Museum, “The Berlin Spy Tunnel.” And Central Intelligence Agency, “A Look Back... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” And Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 50-51. And Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 182-195. And History News Network, “Dwight Eisenhower Built up American Intelligence at a Crucial Moment.” And “Special Exhibition on the Berlin Espionage Tunnel,” Alliierten Museum, last modified April 27, 2006, https://web.archive.org/web/20070928101802/http://www.alliiertenmuseum.de/en/4_1.php?year=&activity_id=123. And The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 273-274. And “V: The Berlin Tunnel,” Central Intelligence Agency, <https://web.archive.org/web/20090805092906/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/index.html>. And Vulcan To The Sky Trust, “Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch.”

³⁵ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 64.

³⁶ Ibid.

³⁷ Ibid, 64-66.

altogether. For the first time in history, a wiretapping operation produced overwhelming amounts of intelligence, which also acted as a frontier for mass surveillance operations in modern-day society.

Indeed, once discovered, the tunnel captured the attention of the press. The *Washington Post* reported that “Yankee resourcefulness and ingenuity is not a myth after all”;³⁸ and that same thought was conveyed in the *Boston Post*, who claimed they “didn’t know that American intelligence agents were that smart.”³⁹ The press made it clear that Operation Gold, while unethical, was “a stark necessity in the world of cynical power politics”⁴⁰ in the United States’ rise to power. One newspaper, the *Stamford Advocate*, even went on to blatantly express their support for the CIA’s efforts by saying that the “Russians [were] just old meanies to claim we wire-tapped.”⁴¹ For the first time, American press coverage started to support the CIA, which became a frontier in “strengthen[ing] the impression of [the CIA] and [restoring] some measure of [the CIA’s] prestige.”⁴² The CIA was no longer “a stumbling neophyte in espionage,”⁴³ but was now capable of taking down the mighty KGB.

From the Soviet perspective, the operation was an “international scandal”⁴⁴ and a “bitterly serious affair.”⁴⁵ Berlin newspapers and political cartoons “were designed to slander the Americans.”⁴⁶ One such cartoon, featured in *Neues Deutschland* on April 25, 1956, depicted a strong arm pulling out a United States espionage mole and was captioned, “Do Not Burrow in

³⁸ “The Tunnel of Love,” *Washington Post*, May 1, 1956, in *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 81.

³⁹ “Hope It Is True,” *Boston Post*, May 4, 1956, in *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 83.

⁴⁰ Ibid.

⁴¹ “Money Well Spent,” *Stamford (Connecticut) Advocate*, May 12, 1956, in *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 84.

⁴² “The Tunnel of Love,” *Washington Post*, 81.

⁴³ Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 53.

⁴⁴ Ibid, 90-92.

⁴⁵ Ibid.

⁴⁶ Ibid, 91.

Other People's Yards!"⁴⁷ Another that appeared the next day showed Americans trying to milk an oversized telephone into a Counterintelligence Corps bucket.⁴⁸ The Soviets had even managed to show a film scolding the Americans in forty theaters, titled *Stop It!*, within five days of the tunnel's discovery.⁴⁹ The Soviet Press coverage went to great lengths to discredit American ingenuity, and created massive propaganda depicting the United States as a nation of warmongers.

If the Soviet Union's goal was to garner more support for Operation Gold, then they would have succeeded. By taking extensive photographs and drawing detailed sketches of the tunnel,⁵⁰ the Soviet Union's true intention gloriously backfired: the press, both local and foreign, started to focus on the massive engineering feat conducted by the Americans. Local newspapers like the *Frankfurter Neue Presse* expressed great astonishment that the Americans "were capable of so much cleverness."⁵¹ Even American newspapers went out of their way to write, in bolded text, that "Germans Admire [the] Feat"⁵² and "Reds Flock to See 'U.S. Wire-Tap Tunnel'."⁵³ This became a frontier in making the world think the unthinkable: that the United States indeed had a "capacity for daring undertakings."⁵⁴

The CIA suddenly became both a celebrity and a force to fear across the globe. This sentiment was summed by a CIA report on the operation's public reception: "[t]he non-Communist world reacted with surprise and unconcealed delight [...] that the U.S. [...] was capable of a coup against the Soviet Union, which had long been the acknowledged master in

⁴⁷ See Appendix B.

⁴⁸ See Appendix C.

⁴⁹ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 286

⁵⁰ Clandestine Services History, "The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956," 89-100.

⁵¹ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 287.

⁵² John H. Thompson, "Reds Man Guns At 'Spy Tunnel' Outside Berlin," *Chicago Tribune*, May 29, 1956, in *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 87.

⁵³ Gaston Coblentz, "Reds Flock to See 'U.S. Wire-Tap Tunnel'," *New York Herald Tribune*, May 27, 1956, in *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 81.

⁵⁴ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 288.

[espionage and counterintelligence] matters.”⁵⁵ Not only that, but the tunnel was declared to be “the most highly publicized peacetime espionage enterprise in modern times.”⁵⁶ Even the KGB officials were “flabbergasted”⁵⁷ and “could not believe [their] eyes”⁵⁸ at the “explosive material.”⁵⁹ With the globe applauding the United States’ efforts, Operation Gold became a frontier for a new era in the world — one where the United States directly rivaled the Soviet Union.

To the dismay of SIS head of the Berlin station Peter Lunn, British involvement was never mentioned to the press. Coincidentally, First Secretary Nikita Khrushchev was touring Great Britain from April 18-27, meaning that Khrushchev was in Great Britain when the tunnel was discovered.⁶⁰ For this reason, Prime Minister Anthony Eden refused to compromise the success of the visit by revealing their involvement in the tunnel.⁶¹ The operation, which aided the United States and Great Britain in obtaining Soviet battle strategies and significantly boosted the intelligence productivity of the CIA and the SIS, began to quickly disappear from the SIS’s history due to the lack of recognition.

Sadly, the KGB revealed that they knew of the Operation all along in April 1961, leading to multiple sources attempting to overshadow the effect of the tunnel, claiming that the United States and Great Britain were fed disinformation by the KGB.⁶² However, the KGB was only able to detect the tunnel through George Blake, which meant that providing misinformation would have made Blake a suspect of British betrayal. And Blake was simply too important of a source for the KGB to be compromised. Consequently, the KGB did nothing to thwart the

⁵⁵ Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 53.

⁵⁶ Clandestine Services History, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956,” 53.

⁵⁷ Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 160.

⁵⁸ Ibid. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 126.

⁵⁹ Hermiston, *The Greatest Traitor*, 160. And Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 126.

⁶⁰ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 257-288.

⁶¹ The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).”

⁶² Murphy and Kondrashev and Bailey, *Battleground Berlin*, 205-208.

tunnel.⁶³ Blake would even go on to say, “I’m sure 99.9% of the information obtained by the SIS and CIA from the tunnel was genuine,”⁶⁴ proving the success of Operation Gold.

But the damage was already done — the “best publicity the U.S. [...] had in Berlin”⁶⁵ was short-lived. Regardless, the intelligence value produced by the United States thrust them toward becoming a global superpower — a move that showed the world the potential of the United States, giving them the ability to undertake advanced espionage and counterintelligence operations previously unheard of.

Operation Gold secured a crucial chapter in the United States’ history. With the disaster of “Black Friday”, when the Soviet Union switched to landlines, the United States was plagued with no funding and intel. But the tunnel revived the United States, as there was “no other way to obtain [the] information except what was coming through [the] tunnel.”⁶⁶ The tunnel was a much-needed score for the United States, as it brought them “a highly valuable flow of raw intelligence,” which was a frontier for the United States’ prowess in espionage.

Operation Gold also aided key players in their careers. Bill Harvey became America’s “James Bond,”⁶⁷ and in 1961, he was appointed to lead some of the CIA’s darkest missions. Harvey created the very first CIA assassination program, ZR/RIFLE, which was heavily used in assassination plots on Fidel Castro, the Prime Minister of Cuba, who was a staunch ally of the Soviet Union during the Cold War. The news that “Bill was running the show”⁶⁸ was spread so that the Soviet Union, especially the KGB, would “immediately [realize the United States] meant business over Cuba.”⁶⁹ Harvey’s image became one to fear for even the KGB, which was

⁶³ Ibid.

⁶⁴ The Cold War Museum, “The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).”

⁶⁵ “BERLIN,” *TIME* 67, no. 19 (May 7, 1956): 44, <https://time.com/vault/issue/1956-05-07/page/44/>.

⁶⁶ Vogel, *Betrayal in Berlin*, 194.

⁶⁷ Ibid, 371.

⁶⁸ Ibid, 370.

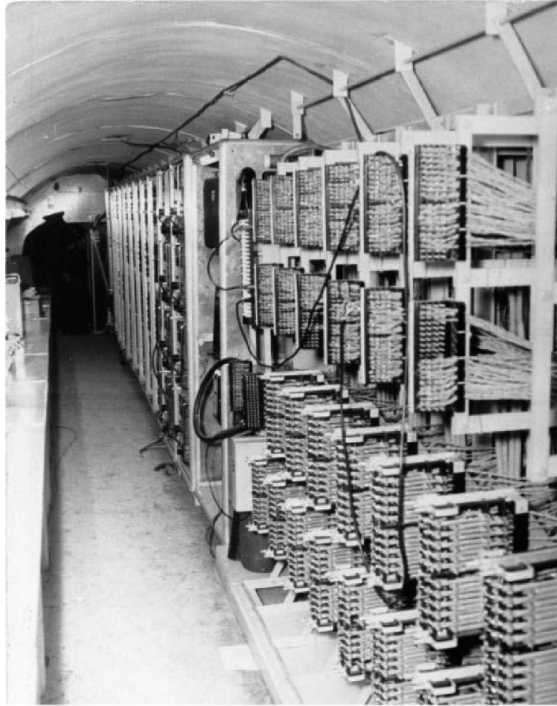
⁶⁹ Ibid.

advantageous for the CIA as they could now run even more daring operations. The tunnel's success propelled Harvey and others into leading various secret projects, ultimately expanding and acting as a frontier for the CIA's — and the United States' — intelligence grasp on the world.

Conclusion

Operation Gold, albeit having a short span and often overshadowed, marked the start of a new chapter in intelligence for the United States. It showed the world that the United States was willing to spend large amounts of money on audacious espionage operations, which gave the country a newfound respect. For the first time, there was a colossal amount of quality intelligence gathered, which was a revolutionary development for both the CIA and SIS. Furthermore, Operation Gold became a frontier for the United States to carry out more expansive espionage and counterintelligence operations, partly due to the tunnel becoming the spectacle of the press. While the operation was very short-lived and eventually lost to mainstream history, its value of revolutionizing intelligence amidst the Cold War, and setting an example for future clandestine operations, is still present — Operation Gold was vital for the United States to become a global superpower.

Appendix A



“Shown here: a look at the central monitoring station with the amplifier system.”

Junge, Heinz. *Zentralbild/Junge*. Photograph. April 24, 1956. Das Bundesarchiv.

https://bild.bundesarchiv.de/device_barch/dev1/2019/10-15/53/13/file77jt6752b5gpxp3vny3.jpg.

Appendix B

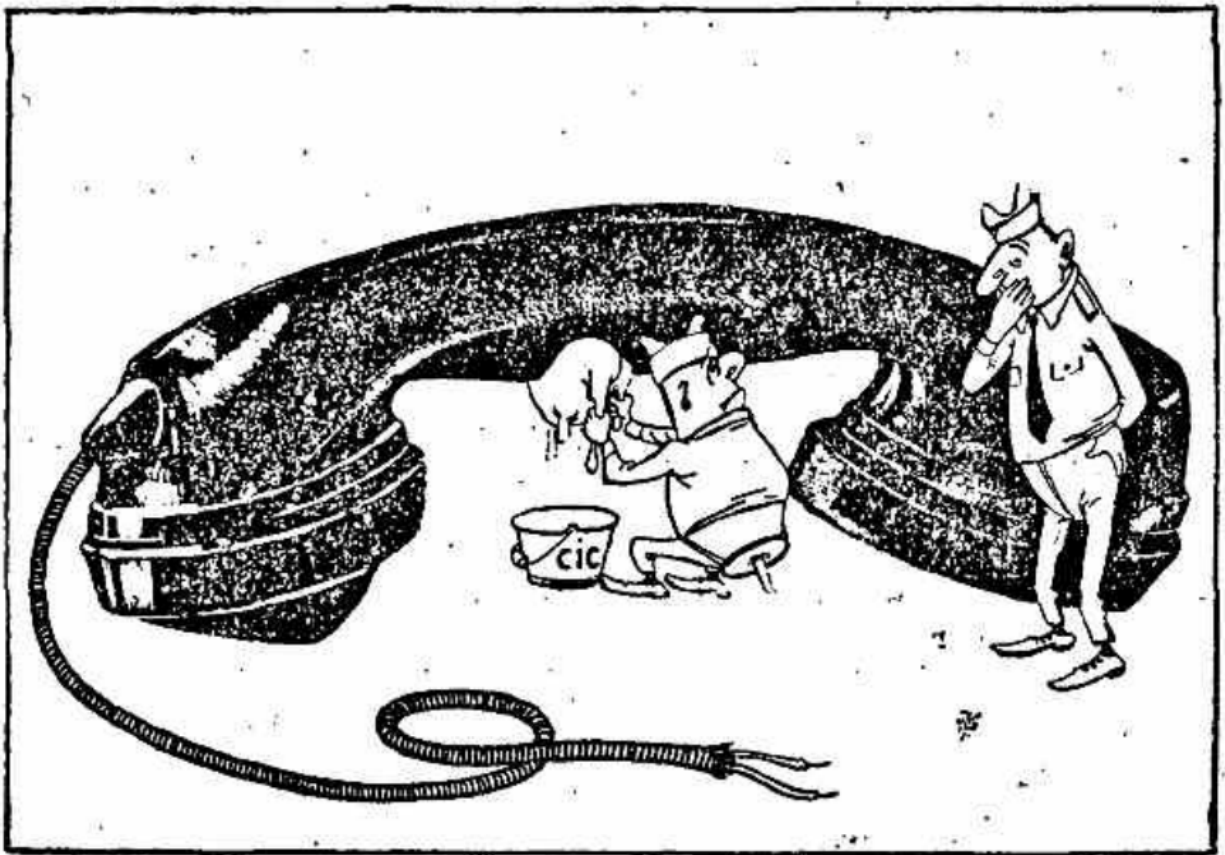


“Do Not Burrow in Other People’s Yards!”

Berg. *Nicht in fremden Gärten wühlen!* Illustration. April 25, 1956. Neues Deutschland.

https://dfg-viewer.de/show?id=9&tx_dlf%5Bid%5D=https%3A%2F%2Fcontent.staatsbibliothek-berlin.de%2Fzefys%2FSNP2532889X-19560425-0-0-0-0.xml&tx_dlf%5Bpage%5D=6.

Appendix C



Ausgezapft!

Zeichnung: Arndt

“Tapped!”

Arndt. *Ausgezapft!* Illustration. April 26, 1956. Neues Deutschland.

https://dfg-viewer.de/show?tx_dlf%5Bdouble%5D=0&tx_dlf%5Bid%5D=https%3A%2F%2Fcontent.staatsbibliothek-berlin.de%2Fzefys%2FSNP2532889X-19560426-0-0-0-0.xml&tx_dlf%5Bpage%5D=6&cHash=a08436d1afec59e6de7198ba5640c11e

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Arndt. *Ausgezapft!* Illustration. April 26, 1956. Neues Deutschland.

https://dfg-viewer.de/show?tx_dlf%5Bdouble%5D=0&tx_dlf%5Bid%5D=https%3A%2F%2Fcontent.staatsbibliothek-berlin.de%2Fzefys%2FSNP2532889X-19560426-0-0-0-0.xml&tx_dlf%5Bpage%5D=6&cHash=a08436d1afec59e6de7198ba5640c11e.

In my paper, this cartoon was placed in Appendix C to further the reader's understanding of the Soviet press coverage of Operation Gold at the time. Additionally, it was used to support how the Soviets tried to vilify the United States.

Berg. *Nicht in fremden Gärten wühlen!* Illustration. April 25, 1956. Neues Deutschland.

https://dfg-viewer.de/show?id=9&tx_dlf%5Bid%5D=https%3A%2F%2Fcontent.staatsbibliothek-berlin.de%2Fzefys%2FSNP2532889X-19560425-0-0-0-0.xml&tx_dlf%5Bpage%5D=6.

In my paper, this cartoon was placed in Appendix B to help the reader understand the Soviet Union press's attempts to slander the United States.

"BERLIN." *TIME* 67, no. 19 (May 7, 1956): 44.

<https://time.com/vault/issue/1956-05-07/page/44/>.

This magazine clipping showed me what the conclusions of the American press were after seeing the tunnel. It also helped me understand the astonishment of the general press, both American and Soviet. In my paper, this source contributed multiple quotes, and aided my understanding of the tunnel's legacy.

Blake, George. *No Other Choice: An Autobiography*. New York: Simon & Schuster, 1990.

This autobiography exactly informed me what information George Blake had given to the KGB, and gave me an idea of how much he had compromised Operation Gold. As Blake wrote the original meeting minutes between the CIA and SIS, he included major details on the operation, some that were even redacted in CIA publications. In my paper, this source was used to provide numerous specifications on the tunnel and to capture the KGB's feelings about the tunnel.

Coblentz, Gaston. "Reds Flock to See 'U.S. Wire-Tap Tunnel'." *New York Herald Tribune*, May 27, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 86.

This newspaper clipping gave me an idea of how the American press was supporting the Central Intelligence Agency, and captured thoughts on the intricate equipment used. This source also depicted the American sentiment on the tunnel clearly, and gave limited information on the Soviet perspective. In my paper, this source was used to show how American newspapers started to highlight how even the Germans and Soviets were supporting the tunnel for its advanced technology.

Dreier, Alex. "CIA May Have Ordered Wiretap Tunnel -- Dreier." *National Broadcasting Company*, May 17, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 85.

This radio transcript displayed renewed support for the tunnel, and described how the American press was very eager to attribute the tunnel to the United States, although American officials vehemently denied this for diplomatic reasons. This transcript specifically showed how the press even wanted to make the West Berlin (American Sector) side of the tunnel into a tourist attraction, due to the amount of publicity the operation was receiving. In my paper, this source reinforced my knowledge of the general American sentiment on the tunnel.

"East Germans File a Wiretap Protest." *New York Times*, April 26, 1956.
https://timesmachine.nytimes.com/timesmachine/1956/04/26/86564266.pdf?pdf_redirect=true&ip=0.

This news article explained the tunnel's components and the tunnel's purpose from the eyes of the press, as well as the amazement of the press at the engineering marvel. This clipping, moreover, highlighted the Soviet Union's desire to spread negative propaganda on the United States, as well as the American press spreading the negative propaganda in a positive light (and thus, negating the Soviet Union's efforts). In my paper, this source furthered my understanding of how the Soviet Union's goal of portraying the United States as a vile country completely backfired.

Fellon, Gerard. "Turning a Cold War Scheme into Reality." *Studies in Intelligence* 52, no. 1 (March 2008).
[https://web.archive.org/web/20090513190505/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/csi-studies/studies/vol-52-no-1/pdf-files/\(U\)%20Berlin%20Tunnel%20\(Web\).pdf](https://web.archive.org/web/20090513190505/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/csi-studies/studies/vol-52-no-1/pdf-files/(U)%20Berlin%20Tunnel%20(Web).pdf).

This source gave a first-hand account of the planning and execution of Operation Gold. As Gerard Fellon was an engineer on the team, this source was able to describe some of

the hurdles that Operation Gold faced during the construction of the tunnel, and provide numerous details on the American warehouse at Rudow. In my paper, this source was used to describe the American warehouse, and show the panic that occurred on-site during the tunnel's discovery.

"Hope It Is True." *Boston Post*, May 4, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 83.

This newspaper clipping informed me how the American press, who previously had no faith in American intelligence triumphing against Soviet intelligence, was now ecstatic that the United States pulled the operation off. Additionally, this source described how the tunnel, while unethical by diplomatic standards, was completely necessary for the United States to rise to power and rival the Soviet Union. In my paper, this source highlighted the American press's disbelief that the United States had the power to conduct Operation Gold, as well as reinforced the idea that this was essential for the United States to become a superpower.

Junge, Heinz. *Zentralbild/Junge*. Photograph. April 24, 1956. Das Bundesarchiv. https://bild.bundesarchiv.de/device_barch/dev1/2019/10-15/53/13/file77jt6752b5gpxp3vny3.jpg.

In my paper, this image was placed in Appendix A to visually show the extensive use of technology in the tunnel for the reader's benefit.

"Money Well Spent." *Stamford (Connecticut) Advocate*, May 12, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 84.

This newspaper clipping described how the Central Intelligence Agency was willing to spend millions of dollars on Operation Gold and future espionage operations. Furthermore, this source included the fact that people living in Berlin also supported the tunnel. In my paper, this source was used to explain how the press was siding with the United States and even denying the claim that the tunnel was American (along with American officials).

Murphy, David E., Sergei A. Kondrashev, and George Bailey. *Battleground Berlin: CIA vs. KGB in the Cold War*. New Haven: Yale University Press, 1997.

This book expressed the fact that Operation Gold had been gathering a bad reputation due to misinformation, as multiple publications said that American information was diluted by the KGB. Sergei A. Kondrashev, who was George Blake's KGB handler, included lots

of classified details passed onto him by Blake, which made this source a primary source. In my paper, this source was mainly used to detail Operation Silver, as well as describe the construction of the tunnel.

“Operation REGAL: The Berlin Tunnel.” *National Security Agency*, 1988.

https://www.nsa.gov/portals/75/documents/news-features/declassified-documents/cryptologic-histories/operation_regal.pdf.

This report detailed how the National Security Agency collaborated with an enemy — the Central Intelligence Agency — to produce usable intelligence, and also included the discovery of the tunnel. Even though multiple parts of the source were redacted, lots of details were given on the layout of the tunnel and what the tunnel produced. In my paper, this source contributed a thorough knowledge of the types of intelligence successfully produced by Operation Gold.

Press, Associated. “Reds Play Up the Berlin Tunnel.” *New York Times*, April 29, 1956.

https://timesmachine.nytimes.com/timesmachine/1956/04/29/84691764.pdf?pdf_redirect=true&ip=0.

This news article provided more confirmation that the Soviet Union was trying to use propaganda to win the press on their side in the Cold War. In my paper, this source helped to consolidate my understanding of the Soviet reception of Operation Gold.

Sullivan, Walter. “Russians Say U.S. Taps Berlin Wire.” *New York Times*, April 24, 1956.

https://timesmachine.nytimes.com/timesmachine/1956/04/24/84688529.pdf?pdf_redirect=true&ip=0.

This primary source news article gave me insight into the craze of the press at the time, as well as how the Soviet Union was trying to portray the United States as a nation of warmongers. Additionally, this newspaper clipping showed me that the press knew the scale of Operation Gold, leading to more support for the United States. In my paper, this source was used for me to understand the initial thoughts of the press during the tunnel’s discovery.

Sullivan, Walter. “U.S. Investigates Wiretap Tunnel.” *New York Times*, April 25, 1956.

https://timesmachine.nytimes.com/timesmachine/1956/04/25/86563419.pdf?pdf_redirect=true&ip=0.

This news article consolidated the route of the tunnel with maps and explained what the Soviet Union was accusing the United States of doing. Additionally, this newspaper

clipping showed that the Soviet Union was indeed taking people to tour the tunnel, in a big effort to show how vile the United States was. In my paper, this source was used to give me an understanding of the press reception, and how it could have been influenced by Soviet Union propaganda attempts.

“The Tunnel of Love.” *Washington Post*, May 1, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 81.

This newspaper clipping heavily emphasized the reception of Operation Gold from the perspective of the press. The American press coverage started to support the United States in its intelligence battle against the Soviets due to the magnitude of Operation Gold. In my paper, this source was used to describe how the press had renewed their confidence in the United States, and helped me analyze Operation Gold’s effect on the public.

Thompson, John H. “Reds Man Guns At ‘Spy Tunnel’ Outside Berlin.” *Chicago Tribune*, May 29, 1956. In *The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956*, Clandestine Services History, 87.

This newspaper clipping made it clear to me that the Soviet Union was extensively looking for opportunities to discredit the United States’ ingenuity in Operation Gold. Additionally, the newspaper used every chance to describe how even the Soviets admired the tunnel. In my paper, this source was used to show how American newspapers were displaying how the tunnel was favored even by the Soviets.

“The Berlin Tunnel Operation 1952-1956.” *Clandestine Services History*, June 24, 1968.
<https://web.archive.org/web/20170118070821/https://www.cia.gov/library/readingroom/docs/CIA-RDP07X00001R000100010001-9.pdf>.

This report, compiled by the Central Intelligence Agency, had details from Operation Gold’s inception to the discovery of the tunnel. Additionally, this source had lots of information on the reception of the press, both American and Soviet. In my paper, this source was used to include quotations from Central Intelligence Agency and Secret Intelligence Service officials, as well as key information on the tunnel’s construction and press reception.

“V-1: Field Project Outline, 16 September 1953.” *Clandestine Services History*, September 16, 1953,
<https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025335/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-1.pdf>.

This report included the very basic details of the operation, but was an effective memorandum in conveying the idea of Operation Gold. In my paper, this source gave me a good initial understanding of Operation Gold, and was used to further my research.

“V-2: Memorandum for COM Frankfurt from COB Berlin; Progress Report--28 August through 17 October 1954, 18 October 1954.” *Clandestine Services History*, October 18, 1954, <https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025342/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-2.pdf>.

This memorandum included a list of hurdles that the engineers faced while digging the tunnel. This report helped obtain the exact dates of when various issues started and stopped, most notably the dates of the water table incident. In my paper, this source was used to further my understanding of how hard digging the tunnel was, as well as the issues that the engineers faced during construction.

“V-3: Memorandum for the Record, 29 November 1954.” *Clandestine Services History*, November 29, 1954, <https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025351/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-3.pdf>.

This report included details on the tight security that was necessary on-site, and justified specific construction and design choices with security concerns. In my paper, this source provided an understanding of how the Berlin Operating Base officials were to act in a case of discovery — which was the same procedure followed by the staff when the tunnel was discovered.

“V-4: Clandestine Services History Program (CSHP) History: Soviet Discovery of the Berlin Tunnel, 15 August 1956.” *Clandestine Services History*, August 15, 1956, <https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025303/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-4.pdf>.

This report detailed all of the events that led to the tunnel’s eventual discovery, and described what was happening while Soviet troops “accidentally” discovered the tunnel. Additionally, this source listed every single step that the Soviet troops took to get into the tunnel, which made it clear that someone had been helping them — namely, George Blake and the hand-drawn maps he had provided almost two years before. In my paper,

this source greatly aided my understanding of how the Soviets staged the discovery of the tunnel.

“V-5: CSHP History: Soviet Discovery of the Berlin Tunnel, (Tape Transcript) Undated.”

Clandestine Services History,

<https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025319/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-5.pdf>.

This report contained a detailed transcript of every action that the Soviet troops took, which was recorded by microphones and amplifiers located in the tunnel. This source depicted the troops as not knowing what the tunnel was, even getting confused by fake signs put up around the tunnel by Bill Harvey, yet showed that the troops' commanding officers had some external knowledge of the tunnel. In my paper, this source contributed a detailed understanding of what went on on the night of the tunnel's discovery.

“V-6: CSHP History of the Berlin Tunnel, G. Berlin Tunnel, Undated.” *Clandestine Services History*,

<https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025257/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-6.pdf>.

This report contained information on the unexpected discovery of the tunnel, how it was leaked by George Blake, and provided brief results on what Operation Gold captured. This source also analyzed what sort of intelligence was coming through the tapped cables, such as the exposing of Secret Intelligence Service moles. In my paper, this source was used to obtain a basic understanding of how Operation Gold became a frontier for future espionage and clandestine operations, partly due to the intelligence coming through the taps.

“V-7: CSHP History of the Berlin Tunnel, V. Production, [from the Berlin Tunnel Operation], Undated.” *Clandestine Services History*,

<https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025329/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-7.pdf>.

This report gave an overview of the actual wiretapping process that took place. Additionally, this source described how much information was captured by Operation Gold through the tapped lines. In my paper, this source was used to gain an overview of what Operation Gold had done, and whether it succeeded or not at its purpose.

“V-8: CSHP History of the Berlin Tunnel: Appendix B. Recapitulation of the Intelligence Derived, Undated.” *Clandestine Services History*,
<https://web.archive.org/web/20090514025312/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/5-8.pdf>.

This report described how Operation Gold was a pivotal source of intelligence information at the time, as there were no other means of obtaining intelligence on the Soviet Union. Additionally, this source showed that the tunnel was still valuable, albeit being compromised in infancy. In my paper, this source contributed an understanding of how the tunnel was effective, contrary to claims that the Soviet Union doctored information passing through the tapped cables.

Secondary Sources

“A Look Back ... The Berlin Tunnel: Exposed.” Central Intelligence Agency. June 26, 2009.
<https://web.archive.org/web/20090715053316/https://www.cia.gov/news-information/featured-story-archive/the-berlin-tunnel-exposed.html>.

This source explained Operation Gold’s roots in Operation Silver, and went into detail on the results of Operation Gold. Additionally, major details about the tunnel’s construction were included. In my paper, this source provided important construction details, as well as how the Soviet Union propaganda plan had gone awry.

Bagley, Tennent H. *Spymaster: Startling Cold War Revelations of a Soviet KGB Chief*. New York: Skyhorse Publishing, 2013.

This book contained insight into the way the KGB used Blake’s information through interviews with Blake’s KGB handler, Sergei A. Kondrashev, and included specifications on Operation Silver and Operation Gold (in their respective inception phases). Additionally, this source placed a scope on Blake’s actions, which informed me how he had vitally compromised Operation Gold, but made his motivations clear. In my paper, this source was used to include details of Operation Silver and Operation Gold’s originally planned course.

“Cold War Stories: Operation Gold / Stopwatch.” Vulcan To The Sky Trust. October 30, 2020.
<https://vulcantothesky.org/articles/cold-war-stories-operation-gold-stopwatch/>.

This source mainly described what the Central Intelligence Agency and Secret Intelligence Service had decided upon in their initial meetings. There were also details on the structure of the tunnel, as well as Blake's spying career for the KGB. In my paper, this source was used to indicate the initial proceedings of Operation Gold, in addition to the results of the operation (in terms of intelligence collected).

Collier, Jonathan. "The story of the Berlin Tunnel: What the operations narrative teaches us about covert conflict in an ongoing Cold War." *Butler University*, July 30, 2018, <https://digitalcommons.butler.edu/cgi/viewcontent.cgi?article=1500&context=grtheses>.

This source wrote extensively on George Blake, and how his espionage career in the Cold War led to him betraying Operation Gold. Additionally, this source had background information on Operation Silver. In my paper, this source was used to obtain a thorough background knowledge of Operation Gold and the Cold War tensions happening at the same time.

Hermiston, Roger. *The Greatest Traitor: The Secret Lives of Agent George Blake*. London: Aurum Press Ltd, 2013.

This book split George Blake's life into major sections, and explained what he did in each time period. This source was essential for understanding why George Blake defected, as well as what information Blake had given to the KGB. In my paper, this source was used to describe details on Operation Silver, the Operation Gold proceedings, as well as how Operation Gold was discovered.

"Intelligence Events Timeline — May 11, 1955." Central Intelligence Agency. <https://www.cia.gov/legacy/museum/successful-completion-of-the-berlin-tunnel-operation-gold/>.

This source provided the date of when the tunnel's construction was finished, and when the wiretap, led by the British Royal Engineers, was started. In my paper, this source was used to reinforce the exact date when construction was finished.

Kross, Peter. "Operation Gold: The CIA's Berlin Tunnel." *Military Heritage* 14, no. 6 (Late Spring 2013). <https://warfarehistorynetwork.com/article/operation-gold-the-cias-berlin-tunnel/>.

This source emphasized the value of Operation Silver, and how that continuously played a role in Operation Gold. This article also detailed some of the Cold War tensions going

on at the time, such as the Soviet nuclear program. In my paper, this source was used to describe progress on Operation Silver.

British Broadcasting Corporation. "Obituary: George Blake." December 26, 2020.
<https://www.bbc.com/news/uk-25675566>.

This website gave me background information on who George Blake was, and what types of operations Blake had compromised. In my paper, this source furthered my initial research, and pushed me to dig deeper and research Operation Gold.

Roberts, Steven V. "In Cold War Berlin, the Americans had a tunnel, but the Soviets had a mole." The Washington Post. November 8, 2019.
https://www.washingtonpost.com/outlook/in-cold-war-berlin-the-americans-had-a-tunnel-but-the-soviets-had-a-mole/2019/11/08/d7fa0328-b714-11e9-a091-6a96e67d9cce_story.html.

This source had background information on why George Blake chose to defect to the KGB in the first place, as well as the cost of the operation and what materials were used. In my paper, this source was used to further initial research and gave me a broader understanding of how big Operation Gold was at the time, especially amidst all of the Cold War tensions.

"Special Exhibition on the Berlin Espionage Tunnel." Alliierten Museum. April 27, 2006.
https://web.archive.org/web/20070928101802/http://www.alliiertenmuseum.de/en/4_1.php?year=&activity_id=123.

This source recorded the dimensions of the tunnel, and went into detail on the betrayal Blake had committed. It also provided some photographs of the tunnel. In my paper, this source was used to further initial research, and include the results of the tunnel in terms of intelligence obtained.

Stafford, David. *Spies Beneath Berlin*. New York: Woodstock, 2003.

This book provided an introduction to the various tensions Operation Gold was facing, and the reasons its success was vital. Multiple diagrams were provided, which were very helpful for understanding the jargon included in the book. In my paper, this source was used to describe Operation Silver, Operation Gold's initial proceedings and construction, and the eventual discovery of the tunnel.

“The Berlin Spy Tunnel.” Alliierten Museum.

<https://www.alliiertenmuseum.de/en/objekt/the-berlin-spy-tunnel/>.

This source provided numerous images of the tunnel and indicated the dates that the tunnel was in use. Additionally, this website included some details on what intelligence the tunnel had obtained. In my paper, this source contributed design specifications on the tunnel, as well as the abundance of intelligence that Operation Gold had obtained.

“The Berlin Tunnel Operation Gold (U.S.) Operation Stopwatch (U.K.).” The Cold War Museum.

https://web.archive.org/web/20120902022151/http://www.coldwar.org/articles/50s/berlin_tunnel.asp.

This source went into detail on the inception of the tunnel, as well as the complete construction process of the tunnel. This website included multiple quotes from agents in the operation as well. In my paper, this source provided details on Project VENONA, specifications of the tunnel, and important dates in the construction of the tunnel.

“V: The Berlin Tunnel.” Central Intelligence Agency.

<https://web.archive.org/web/20090727223725/https://www.cia.gov/library/center-for-the-study-of-intelligence/csi-publications/books-and-monographs/on-the-front-lines-of-the-cold-war-documents-on-the-intelligence-war-in-berlin-1946-to-1961/art-7.html>.

This source indicated that Operation Gold was able to gain numerous Soviet battle tactics and force dispositions, in addition to including a breakdown of the tunnel’s construction. The KGB’s knowledge of the tunnel, and their non-involvement, was also justified. In my paper, this source was used to explain how much intelligence Operation Gold had succeeded in obtaining.

Vogel, Steve. *Betrayal in Berlin: The True Story of The Cold War’s Most Audacious Espionage Operation*. New York: HarperCollins Publishers Inc, 2019.

This book was filled with information on the CIA and SIS’s interactions, the operation, and Blake. Additionally, this book gave me a history of Blake’s motivations, and Cold War tensions going on, which helped me progress through my initial research and selecting the topic of my paper. In my paper, this source was used to obtain multiple quotes from agents who were a part of the tunnel, as well as include crucial dates and details (provided by interviews with Blake) on Operation Gold.

Vogel, Steve. "Dwight Eisenhower Built up American Intelligence at a Crucial Moment." History News Network. September 20, 2020.
<https://historynewsnetwork.org/article/177379>.

This source provided me with the history of Operation VENONA, and why Operation Gold had been thought of in the first place. In addition, connections to modern-day society, especially the National Security Agency, were present in this source. In my paper, this source provided information on how the Americans were desperate for more intelligence, and described the results of Operation Gold.

Volkman, Ernest. *Spies: The Secret Agents Who Changed The Course of History*. London: Wiley, 1997.

In the chapter on George Blake, this book highlighted the importance of Blake to the Soviet Union and why the KGB remained silent for the majority of the operation. Additionally, this source provided a perspective on how the Soviet Union benefitted from Blake's information. In my paper, this source gave me an understanding of Blake's motivations for compromising Operation Gold, and who he was as a person.